



**Last hurrah:** Scotland scored two goals in stoppage time against Denmark to secure a place in the 2026 FIFA World Cup. AP

end of matchday five, Arsenal tops the standings with a perfect record, while Paris Saint-Germain, Bayern, Inter and Real Madrid follow with 12 points each.

### International

An overhead kick, a stoppage-time winner and a goal from the middle of the pitch — these were the moments of madness Scotland needed against Denmark to qualify for the FIFA World Cup for the first time since 1998. On a booming night in Glasgow, with a win required to qualify, Scott McTominay leapt high in the air and produced an outrageous acrobatic attempt in the third minute to send the supporters into ecstasy.

However, Denmark fought back,

with Rasmus Hojlund converting from the spot in the second half. Scotland restored its lead through Lawrence Shankland, but it did not last long as Manchester United's Patrick Dorgu restored parity. With yet another heartbreak looming for Scotland, it was former Arsenal defender Kieran Tierney who took matters into his own hands in the third minute of stoppage time with a clinical curling strike from outside the box. Five minutes later, midfielder Kenny McLean slammed the final nail in the coffin with a shot from the halfway mark to catch Denmark goalkeeper Kasper Schmeichel off his goal line, securing the Scots' place at next year's World Cup.

Elsewhere in Europe, the usual

suspects — Spain, Belgium and Switzerland — also secured qualification after finishing top of their respective groups.

Meanwhile, in the CONCACAF qualifiers, some of the smallest nations made the biggest waves by booking their tickets to the premier tournament. The tiny Caribbean nation of Curacao, with a population of just over 156,000, became the smallest country ever to qualify after battling to a 0-0 draw with Jamaica to finish top of its group with 12 points from six games.

Curacao was joined by Haiti and Panama, which beat Nicaragua and El Salvador, respectively, to fill the final two spots.

**(All results updated as of December 1)**